

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

When are you free for a meeting?



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can ask when people are free.
- I can say what I'm doing now.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you had a work meeting?
- When do you prefer to have a meeting? Why?





Let's Explore!

Miranda **requests*** a meeting with Peter. What does he say? Let's find out.

* Politely asking for something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Hello Peter. I'm just dropping by to see when you're free. I see you responded to Janet's request to write the proposal to Farmani.
- Pete** r: Oh hi Miranda. Hey, would you mind waiting a minute? I'm just talking on the phone with my mother. You know she's hoping I can take the week off.
- Miranda:** Yes. Well, tell her I hope she's well and that your workmates are glad you can keep up with some pressing responsibilities.
- Peter:** I will. But say, would you be available to meet after lunch? I'd like some time to order my thoughts.
- Miranda:** Actually, I'd like to meet earlier. I need to provide you with some information for those thoughts you plan to order. I think it's rather crucial you know something about my meeting with Farmani.
- Peter:** How soon are you thinking?
- Miranda:** Well, I'm thinking about now. I'm having a meeting with Ferdinand at 10:30.
- Peter:** How much time will you need?
- Miranda:** With Ferdinand, an hour. With you, 30 minutes.
- Peter:** Alright then, would you be available for a coffee at 11:30?
- Miranda:** Fine. If you need to talk with me before then, feel free to come by my office. I'm scheduling my meeting with Greta now.
- Peter:** Greta? Oh, mom. I have to go. Miranda? I'll come now.





Let's Practice!

What is Peter doing? What about Miranda?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Compare your pronunciation with a partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) can / week / the / I / She's / off. / take / hoping

2) are / thinking? / you / soon / How

3) about / now. / I'm / thinking

4) Ferdinand / 10:30. / a / I'm / meeting / having / with / at

5) providing / information. / I'm / you / some / with



Let's Practice!

When is Peter free for a meeting?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the sentences with the Word Bank options.

1) _____ waiting for a minute?

2) I'm just _____ to _____.

3) I was hoping I could _____.

4) Would you be _____
_____ after lunch?

5) Would you be _____

a _____ at 11:30?.

Word Bank

- coffee
- available to
- dropping by
- meet
- available for
- Would you mind
- when you're free
- take the week off
- see



Extension Activity

It's time to schedule a meeting.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you are a manager at a company. Write a short dialogue where you schedule a meeting with one of your staff members.
- Work with a partner to act out the dialogue. One of you will play the role of the manager and the other will play the role of the staff member.
- Is there anything you can change to the dialogue to make scheduling a meeting easier?

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a short dialogue.

☐ ☐

I understand how to schedule a meeting.

☐ ☐

I use appropriate language for scheduling a meeting.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to drop by** (expression): to make a short visit somewhere
e.g. I'm just dropping by to see how you're doing.
- **see when you're free** (expression): to check when someone is available
e.g. I was hoping to see when you're free for our meeting.
- **to take the week off** (expression): to stop working for a period of one week
e.g. I was hoping I would take the week off.
- **pressing responsibilities** (noun): very important duties you need to deal with
e.g. I'm glad you can keep up with some pressing responsibilities.
- **to order my thoughts** (expression): to plan what you want to say or do
e.g. I'd like some time to order my thoughts.
- **crucial** (noun): very important
e.g. I think it's crucial you know something about my meeting with Sarah.





Learning Points

Present Continuous

The Present Continuous tense is formed by "be" and the present participle (-ing) of a verb.

The **Present Continuous** tense is normally used to talk about an action happening in the present or at the moment. However, it can also be used to indicate future. It basically expresses the idea that something will (or will not) happen in the future. The future can be noticed through the use of a future word.

Spoken English

The **Present Continuous** tense is very common in spoken English. Below you will find a list with the most common verbs used with the **Present Continuous** in spoken English.

I am ...	1. going 2. saying 3. doing 4. trying 5. talking 6. looking 7. telling 8. asking 9. getting 10. being
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Examples:

- *I'm just **stopping** by to say hi.*
- *I'm **talking** with my mom on Skype.*
- *I'm **having** a meeting with Ferdinand **at 3 pm.***





Learning Points

Asking When People are Free

It is important to inquire when you want to find out about someone's availability. Here are some phrases you can use:

<i>I'm just</i>	<i>dropping by</i> <i>stopping by</i>	to	<i>see</i> <i>check</i>	<i>when you're</i>	<i>free.</i> <i>available.</i>
<i>Would you mind ...</i>		<i>waiting</i> until after lunch? <i>meeting</i> in the afternoon? <i>talking</i> tomorrow?			

The adjective 'available' (used before a noun) is commonly used in the following patterns when asking about people's availability.

Examples:

- ***be + available + to + verb***

*Would you **be available to** meet after lunch?*

- ***be + available + for + noun / -ing***

*Would you **be available for** a coffee after the meeting?*

- ***be + readily / freely / easily / widely available***

*I **am easily available for** a coffee in the late afternoon.*

